

MATH 120 AA
Precalculus
Course type: Unknown

Taught by: Arman Jahangiri

Instructor Evaluated: Arman Jahangiri-Grad TA

Evaluation Delivery: Online
Evaluation Form: F
Responses: 14/25 (56% high)

Overall Summative Rating represents the combined responses of students to the four global summative items and is presented to provide an overall index of the class's quality:

Combined Median	Adjusted Combined Median
3.7	3.9
(0=lowest; 5=highest)	

Challenge and Engagement Index (CEI) combines student responses to several *IASystem* items relating to how academically challenging students found the course to be and how engaged they were:

CEI: 4.7
(1=lowest; 7=highest)

SUMMATIVE ITEMS

	N	Excellent (5)	Very Good (4)	Good (3)	Fair (2)	Poor (1)	Very Poor (0)	Median	Adjusted Median
The quiz section as a whole was:	14	29%	14%	50%	7%			3.4	3.6
The content of the quiz section was:	14	21%	36%	36%	7%			3.7	3.9
The quiz section instructor's (QSI's) contribution to the course was:	14	43%	21%	36%				4.2	4.3
The QSI's effectiveness in teaching the subject matter was:	14	43%	7%	43%	7%			3.5	3.7

STUDENT ENGAGEMENT

	N	Much Higher (7)	(6)	(5)	Average (4)	(3)	(2)	Much Lower (1)	Median
Relative to other college courses you have taken:									
Do you expect your grade in this course to be:	14	7%	21%	14%	50%		7%		4.4
The intellectual challenge presented was:	14	7%	21%	43%	29%				5.0
The amount of effort you put into this course was:	14		36%	36%	21%	7%			5.1
The amount of effort to succeed in this course was:	14	7%	36%	29%	29%				5.2
Your involvement in course (doing assignments, attending classes, etc.) was:	14	29%	14%	29%	29%				5.2

On average, how many hours per week have you spent on this course, including attending classes, doing readings, reviewing notes, writing papers and any other course related work?

Class median: 7.2 (N=13)

Under 2	2-3	4-5	6-7	8-9	10-11	12-13	14-15	16-17	18-19	20-21	22 or more
	8%	15%	31%	15%	8%	15%	8%				

From the total average hours above, how many do you consider were valuable in advancing your education?

Class median: 7.0 (N=13)

Under 2	2-3	4-5	6-7	8-9	10-11	12-13	14-15	16-17	18-19	20-21	22 or more
	15%	23%	15%	23%	8%	15%					

What grade do you expect in this course?

Class median: 3.5 (N=13)

A (3.9-4.0)	A- (3.5-3.8)	B+ (3.2-3.4)	B (2.9-3.1)	B- (2.5-2.8)	C+ (2.2-2.4)	C (1.9-2.1)	C- (1.5-1.8)	D+ (1.2-1.4)	D (0.9-1.1)	D- (0.7-0.8)	F (0.0)	Pass	Credit	No Credit
	69%		15%	8%					8%					

In regard to your academic program, is this course best described as:

(N=13)

In your major	A core/distribution requirement	An elective	In your minor	A program requirement	Other
23%	46%			15%	15%

STANDARD FORMATIVE ITEMS

	N	Excellent (5)	Very Good (4)	Good (3)	Fair (2)	Poor (1)	Very Poor (0)	Median	Relative Rank
Explanations by the QSI were:	14	43%	14%	29%	14%			4.0	7
QSI's use of examples and illustrations was:	14	29%	36%	29%	7%			3.9	12
Quality of questions or problems raised by QSI was:	14	36%	21%	36%	7%			3.8	16
QSI's enthusiasm was:	14	29%	36%	29%	7%			3.9	17
Student confidence in QSI's knowledge was:	14	43%	21%	36%				4.2	13
Encouragement given students to express themselves was:	14	36%	36%	21%	7%			4.1	11
Answers to student questions were:	14	43%	14%	36%	7%			4.0	8
Interest level of quiz sections was:	14	29%	21%	43%		7%		3.5	15
QSI's openness to student views was:	14	50%	14%	36%				4.5	4
QSI's ability to deal with student difficulties was:	14	50%	7%	43%				4.5	1
Availability of extra help when needed was:	14	50%	14%	36%				4.5	2
Use of quiz section time was:	14	43%	14%	36%	7%			4.0	6
QSI's interest in whether students learned was:	14	50%	14%	36%				4.5	3
Amount you learned in the quiz sections was:	14	21%	29%	43%	7%			3.5	18
Relevance and usefulness of quiz section content were:	14	36%	29%	29%	7%			4.0	10
Coordination between lectures and quiz sections was:	14	36%	21%	43%				3.8	14
Reasonableness of assigned work for quiz section was:	14	43%	21%	36%				4.2	5
Clarity of student responsibilities and requirements was:	14	29%	43%	29%				4.0	9

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STANDARD OPEN-ENDED QUESTIONS

Was this class intellectually stimulating? Did it stretch your thinking? Why or why not?

1. It did stretch my thinking. Sometimes we have to think about a problem in more than one way.
2. Yes, quiz sections stretched my thinking through applying concepts learned in class to the homework problems.
3. Yes this class intellectually stimulating because this course uses your algebra and geometry skills and you have to really think through the problems and think carefully through them
4. I did find this class intellectually stimulating, I could get my homework done but also get practice on the recent material. When Arman went over the test prep, I understood the material better.
5. yes, it clarified the lecture and helped me make sense of the homework
6. yes, it was challenging.
7. I think this class was intellectually stimulating and stretched my thinking because coming to quiz section was very helpful if I needed help on the homework. The TA was great at answering questions and always attempted to make the most of the short time he was given.
8. I think this quiz section was pretty great, for it being 8:30 in the morning Arman had it figured out and ready even if the questions werent super clear, he would work his best and the content actually made more sense when he would break it down into different steps to further expand your thinking.
9. To an extent it was. Math is not my best subject so I have learned a lot this year
10. Yes, the application-style problems really made me think deeply about the course content. I think that this course prepared me well for future math classes.

What aspects of this class contributed most to your learning?

1. I liked how the TA would first go over some problems that most people have trouble in.
2. Going through homework problems.
3. Going to office hours and asking for support during quiz sections
4. I really liked how the TA, allowed us to take time to work on the homework. He also went over it. It really helped me out.
5. working out the homework problems in class
6. doing practice problems
7. I think the time given to ask questions about the homework contributed the most to my learning because that was what gave me the most clear understanding on what I was being asked to do.
8. I think the most helpful parts were when class discussions actually led somewhere and were productive to where each problem we talked through led to another equation or new understanding.
9. Being able to work this my classmates
10. The TA was really helpful in answering my questions. He was able to explain complex problems really well. What I learned during quiz section helped me perform better on the exams.

What aspects of this class detracted from your learning?

1. It's an 8:30, and super far away so we are often really tired.
2. Nothing that I can think of.
3. None of the aspects of the class were detracting all of them felt really helpful
4. Nothing
5. N/A
6. n/a
7. I think the test preps that were required at the beginning of most quiz sections is what most detracted from my learning because solving the problems usually took time away from being able to ask questions on the homework problems.
8. I think just the fact that it was a wee bit early made it a little harder to focus because the difference between a 9:30 and 8:30 surprised me but it was very informative.
9. Nothing really.
10. I don't think anything detracted from my learning.

What suggestions do you have for improving the class?

1. Make it not 8:30 and far. Do one or the other, not both.
2. Nothing that I can think of.
3. Allowing retakes on midterms. Doing more reviews on the subjects that we focus on
4. Nothing
5. I would continue to go through the work as a class instead of individual
6. n/a
7. I don't think the test prep should be required. If someone came to class in need of homework help, going through previous exams (if desired by the student) could be done during office hours or on their own time.
8. I dont think I have a lot of suggestions.
9. Nothing. The section wasn't all that useful for me as the way my TA teaches and I learn weren't always the same so it wasn't always that helpful but I got a lot out of being able to help my classmates and I know that my TA helped many of my classmates very well.
10. I would say doing more practice exams during quiz section, which was really helpful at the end of the quarter.

IASystem Course Summary Reports summarize student ratings of a particular course or combination of courses. They provide a rich perspective on student views by reporting responses in three ways: as frequency distributions, average ratings, and either comparative or adjusted ratings. Remember in interpreting results that it is important to keep in mind the number of students who evaluated the course relative to the total course enrollment as shown on the upper right-hand corner of the report.

Frequency distributions. The percentage of students who selected each response choice is displayed for each item. Percentages are based on the number of students who answered the respective item rather than the number of students who evaluated the course because individual item response is optional.

Median ratings. IASystem reports average ratings in the form of item medians. Although means are a more familiar type of average than medians, they are less accurate in summarizing student ratings. This is because ratings distributions tend to be strongly skewed. That is, most of the ratings are at the high end of the scale and trail off to the low end.

The median indicates the point on the rating scale at which half of the students selected higher ratings, and half selected lower. Medians are computed to one decimal place by interpolation.¹ In general, higher medians reflect more favorable ratings. To interpret median ratings, compare the value of each median to the respective response scale: *Very Poor, Poor, Fair, Good, Very Good, Excellent (0-5); Never/None/Much Lower, About Half/Average, Always/Great/Much Higher (1-7); Slight, Moderate, Considerable, Extensive (1-4)*.

Comparative ratings. IASystem provides a normative comparison for each item by reporting the decile rank of the item median. Decile ranks compare the median rating of a particular item to ratings of the same item over the previous two academic years in all classes at the institution and within the college, school, or division. Decile ranks are shown only for items with sufficient normative data.

Decile ranks range from 0 (lowest) to 9 (highest). For all items, higher medians yield higher decile ranks. The 0 decile rank indicates an item median in the lowest 10% of all scores. A decile rank of 1 indicates a median above the bottom 10% and below the top 80%. A decile rank of 9 indicates a median in the top 10% of all scores. Because average ratings tend to be high, a rating of "good" or "average" may have a low decile rank.

Adjusted ratings. Research has shown that student ratings may be somewhat influenced by factors such as class size, expected grade, and reason for enrollment. To correct for this, IASystem reports **adjusted medians** for summative items (items #1-4 and their combined global rating) based on regression analyses of ratings over the previous two academic years in all classes at the respective institution. If large classes at the institution tend to be rated lower than small classes, for example, the adjusted medians for large classes will be slightly higher than their unadjusted medians.

When adjusted ratings are displayed for summative items, **relative rank** is displayed for the more specific (formative) items. Rankings serve as a guide in directing instructional improvement efforts. The top ranked items (1, 2, 3, etc.) represent areas that are going well from a student perspective; whereas the bottom ranked items (18, 17, 16, etc.) represent areas in which the instructor may want to make changes. Relative ranks are computed by first standardizing each item (subtracting the overall institutional average from the item rating for the particular course, then dividing by the standard deviation of the ratings across all courses) and then ranking those standardized scores.

Challenge and Engagement Index (CEI). Several IASystem items ask students how academically challenging they found the course to be. IASystem calculates the average of these items and reports them as a single index. *The Challenge and Engagement Index (CEI)* correlates only modestly with the global rating (median of items 1-4).

Optional Items. Student responses to instructor-supplied items are summarized at the end of the evaluation report. Median responses should be interpreted in light of the specific item text and response scale used (response values 1-6 on paper evaluation forms).

¹ For the specific method, see, for example, Guilford, J.P. (1965). *Fundamental statistics in psychology and education*. New York: McGraw-Hill Book Company, pp. 49-53.